interest and no substantive authority to address. Thus, it was not until recently that any EU institutions focused exclusively (or even primarily) on the very discrimination that had, decades ago, rendered the continent a necropolis. Even today, antisemitism remains one of the few forms of discrimination to have escaped the explicit attention of the European Court of Justice (EJC), the EU's highest court. It was, instead, broached by a small agency with limited power. That agency was known as the European Union Monitoring Centre (EUMC), the predecessor of today's Fundamental Rights Agency.

THE EUMC

In considering the Centre's establishment in 1996, the European Commission was unambiguous in its reluctance to grant it decision-making authority. The Commission's memo explained: "The point is *not* to take specific measures to combat racism or xenophobia." Indeed, the Commission insisted it would not "modify the system for protecting human rights in the Community or. . .[in] any of its Member States."

In addition to upholding the European Court of Justice's legal limitations (in its "Meroni" doctrine) on the powers of the EU's decentralized agencies (like the EUMC), the Commission may have wanted to avoid the perception that Brussels would unduly interfere in controversial matters where sovereignty dictates "core domestic preferences on ethical issues."[16] Thus the Center was not to intrude on the internal affairs of the Member States and, whatever appearances to the contrary may have been; it stayed true to the (Meroni doctrine and the memo's) original mission.

By 1997, the Centre's charge was clarified in a regulation that called on it to "provide the Community and the Member States . . .with objective, reliable and comparative data. . .on. . .racism, xenophobia *and anti-Semitism* in order to help them *when* they take efforts against these matters." The Centre remained a largely untapped source until after 9/11, when antisemitism's resurgence was impossible to deny.

Yet, having proclaimed anti-Muslim discrimination their top priority following 9/11, the Centre was ill-prepared to also address that cataclysm's antisemitic dimensions and recognize that the far right's traditional victims (i.e., Muslim immigrants) had become (in several states) antisemitism's leading proponents. Instead of confronting this complexity, the Centre tried, in vain, to suppress the data relating to it.

Hence, when researchers from the Centre for Research on Antisemitism (CRA) drafted a synthesis report in 2003 that concluded that the most violent

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